

Q8	
(a)(i)	The energy E of a photon is proportional to its frequency ($E = hf$). The atom can only absorb a photon of energy equal to <u>the difference in two energy levels</u>. From Fig 8.2, we see that <u>the rubidium atom has discrete energy levels</u>, and thus has discrete energy differences, thus only certain frequencies of photons can be absorbed.
(a)(ii)	Energy of photon, $\Delta E = hf = \frac{hc}{\lambda} = \frac{(6.63 \times 10^{-34})(3.00 \times 10^8)}{795 \times 10^{-9}} = 2.502 \times 10^{-19} \text{ J } (= 1.56 \text{ eV})$ Energy difference, $E_A - E_{\text{ground}} = \Delta E$ $E_A - (-4.18)(1.60 \times 10^{-19}) = 2.502 \times 10^{-19}$ $E_A = -4.186 \times 10^{-19} \text{ J}$ $= -2.62 \text{ eV}$
(a)(iii)	The photon is in the <u>infrared</u> part of the electromagnetic spectrum, outside the visible range, so it cannot be seen with the naked eye. OR The visible spectrum is from <u>400 nm to 700 nm / 750 nm</u>, thus the photon's wavelength lies outside the visible range. OR The visible spectrum has <u>wavelengths on the order of 10^{-7} m</u>, and the photon's wavelength is <u>near the edge of this range</u>. OR (not intended solution but accepted due to phrasing of the question) A <i>single</i> photon reaching the eye has a very small intensity, thus it will be hard to see/detect with the naked eye.
(b)	$E = \frac{3}{2} kT = \frac{1}{2} mv^2$ $v = \sqrt{\frac{3kT}{m}} = \sqrt{\frac{3(1.38 \times 10^{-23})(1000)}{86.9 \times 1.66 \times 10^{-27}}}$ $= 535.72 \approx 536 \text{ m s}^{-1}$ OR $PV = NkT = \frac{1}{3} Nm \langle c^2 \rangle$ $\sqrt{\langle c^2 \rangle} = \sqrt{\frac{3kT}{m}} = \sqrt{\frac{3(1.38 \times 10^{-23})(1000)}{86.9 \times 1.66 \times 10^{-27}}}$ $= 535.72 \approx 536 \text{ m s}^{-1}$

(c)	It is the (average) time that the atom stays in that state before it de-excites to another state.	
(d)(i)	Using the de Broglie relation, $p_{\text{photon}} = \frac{h}{\lambda} = \frac{6.63 \times 10^{-34}}{795 \times 10^{-9}} = 8.34 \times 10^{-28} \text{ kg m s}^{-1}$ OR $E = hf = \frac{hc}{\lambda} = pc$ From (a)(ii), $E = 2.502 \times 10^{-19} \text{ J}$ $\therefore p_{\text{photon}} = \frac{E}{c} = \frac{2.502 \times 10^{-19}}{3.00 \times 10^8} = 8.34 \times 10^{-28} \text{ kg m s}^{-1}$ By the principle of conservation of momentum, taking right as positive $p_{\text{atom}} - p_{\text{photon}} = p'_{\text{atom}}$ $\Delta p_{\text{atom}} = p'_{\text{atom}} - p_{\text{atom}} = -p_{\text{photon}}$ Thus $\Delta p_{\text{atom}} = \left -(8.34 \times 10^{-28}) \right$ $= 8.34 \times 10^{-28} \text{ kg m s}^{-1}$	
(d)(ii)	The photons are emitted in randomly in all directions. <u>Since momentum is a vector quantity</u>, the average change in momentum from this process is the <u>vector sum</u> $\Delta \vec{p} = \frac{\Delta \vec{p}_1 + \Delta \vec{p}_2 + \dots + \Delta \vec{p}_N}{N} = \frac{0}{N} = 0$	
(d)(iii)	From Table 8, the lifetime of the atom in state A is 27.6 ns. Since from (d)(ii) we know that, on average, only absorbing a photon causes a change in momentum, therefore, $F = \frac{\Delta p}{\Delta t}$ $= \frac{8.34 \times 10^{-28}}{27.6 \times 10^{-9}}$ $= 3.02 \times 10^{-20} \text{ N}$	
(d)(iv)	The photons required to excite the atom to state B have shorter wavelength and hence greater momentum, thus <u>each interaction causes a greater decrease in momentum of the atom</u>. OR The lifetime of state B is shorter than state A, so <u>it can absorb more photons per unit time</u> OR <u>the average force on the atom is greater.</u>	
(e)	From Fig. 8.4, when the temperature decreases to T_c, <u>the density of the cloud of atoms increases significantly</u>, suggesting that the particles are overlapping. OR	

	From Fig. 8.4, when the temperature is equal to or below T_c , <u>almost all the particles occupy a small space in the middle of the trap</u> , suggesting that the particles are overlapping.	
(f)	From the de Broglie relation, $\lambda = \frac{h}{p} = \frac{h}{\sqrt{3mkT}}$ Since a BEC forms when $\lambda \geq d$, where $T \leq T_c$, and $d \approx \frac{1}{\sqrt[3]{1.00 \times 10^{19}}} = 4.6416 \times 10^{-7} \text{ m}$, $\frac{h}{\sqrt{3mkT_c}} = \frac{1}{\sqrt[3]{n}}$ $T_c = \frac{h^2}{3mk} n^{\frac{2}{3}}$ $= \frac{(6.63 \times 10^{-34})^2}{3(86.9 \times 1.66 \times 10^{-27})(1.38 \times 10^{-23})} (1.00 \times 10^{19})^{\frac{2}{3}}$ $= 3.4164 \times 10^{-7} \approx 3.42 \times 10^{-7} \text{ K}$ <u>Alternative solution without using de Broglie relation (max 3 marks only)</u> From the Heisenberg uncertainty principle, $\Delta x \Delta p \gtrsim h$ Taking $\Delta p \approx p = \sqrt{3mkT}$, $\Delta x \gtrsim \frac{h}{\sqrt{3mkT}}$ Since a BEC forms when the particles “overlap”, i.e. $\Delta x \geq d$, where $T \leq T_c$, and $d \approx \frac{1}{\sqrt[3]{1.00 \times 10^{19}}} = 4.6416 \times 10^{-7} \text{ m}$, $\frac{1}{\sqrt[3]{n}} = \frac{h}{\sqrt{3mkT_c}}$ $T_c = \frac{h^2}{3mk} n^{\frac{2}{3}}$ $= \frac{(6.63 \times 10^{-34})^2}{3(86.9 \times 1.66 \times 10^{-27})(1.38 \times 10^{-23})} (1.00 \times 10^{19})^{\frac{2}{3}}$ $= 3.4164 \times 10^{-7} \approx 3.42 \times 10^{-7} \text{ K}$	